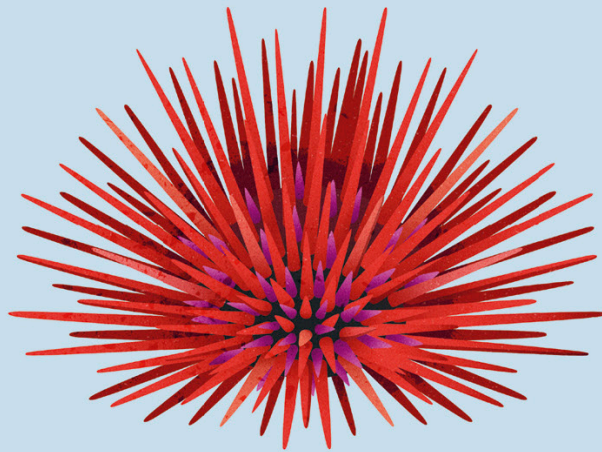


*Sea urchins can detect light, yet have no eyes.
They may use their entire body to see!*

Sea urchin



Sea urchins are the hedgehogs of the sea. Their shell of sharp spines keeps away hungry predators, such as sea otters. Sea urchins inch slowly across the seabed using hundreds of waving tube feet. Each foot ends in a sucker that pulls them along. To get around faster, some sea urchins use crabs as taxis. They hitch a free ride on the crab's back, and in return, the crab gets a spiky bodyguard.

If you turn a sea urchin over you will see its circular mouth. Sea urchins munch almost anything they come across, from seaweed to sponges. Sometimes, they form armies that empty the ocean floor of life, leaving only bare rock and sand.